

Skills

Assessing Apical Pulse

Checklist

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S = Satisfactory U = Unsatisfactory NP = Not Performed

Step	S	U	NP	Comments
Verified health care provider's orders.	☐	☐	☐	
Gathered necessary equipment and supplies.	☐	☐	☐	
Performed hand hygiene.	☐	☐	☐	
Provided patient's privacy.	☐	☐	☐	
Introduced self to patient and family.	☐	☐	☐	
Identified patient using two identifiers.	☐	☐	☐	
Explained the procedure to the patient and ensured that he or she agreed to treatment.	☐	☐	☐	
Assessed for factors that can affect apical pulse rate and rhythm. Used gloves when necessary.	☐	☐	☐	
Helped patient into appropriate position.	☐	☐	☐	
Located PMI properly.	☐	☐	☐	
Slid fingers down to ICS, then to the fifth intercostal space, then over to the left midclavicular line.	☐	☐	☐	
Felt PMI as a light tap reflecting apex of the heart.	☐	☐	☐	
Located PMI if not where expected.	☐	☐	☐	

Identified position of the PMI.

☐☐☐

Warmed diaphragm, cleaned with alcohol, and allowed to dry.

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Placed diaphragm on patient's chest over PMI, and auscultated for normal S₁ and S₂ sounds.

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Looked at watch once sounds were heard with regularity, and took pulse properly.

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Replaced patient's gown and bed linen, helped patient to comfortable position, and discussed findings as appropriate.

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Cleaned earpieces and diaphragm with organization-approved equipment cleaner.

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Placed personal items within reach.

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Placed call light within reach, and ensured patient knew how to use it.

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Raised top side rails and lowered bed to ensure patient safety.

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Disposed of used supplies and equipment, and left patient's room tidy.

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Removed and disposed of gloves when worn, and performed hand hygiene.

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Compared patient's apical pulse rate and rhythm with baseline and acceptable range.

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Documented and reported patient's response and outcomes.

☐☐☐

Learner: _____
Evaluator: _____
Date: _____

Signature: _____
Signature: _____